

Vera

Vera seems to get her tasks done but not always completely. I think it may be a lack of organization. I also don't think she has had the tools necessary to be successful. Over the two months, I found that she failed to post recurring journal entries on several occasions. Depreciation was missing when I reviewed the financial statements for June. A few days later, we determined that a cash entry was also missing. The missing cash entry is not required every month but only in months when the last calendar day falls on a weekend. I recommend that she reclass the outstanding disbursements/checks every month eliminating the need to remember that a month ends on a weekend. Vera does have a checklist, however, the lack of detail on her checklist, does not help her. I have set up a detailed checklist and I have asked her and Mike to review and provide feedback. I think having the detailed checklist should eliminate missing recurring journal entries and should give Vera a tool to keep her on track for always closing the month by no later than the 15th. Eventually that goal will need to move to earlier in the month.

Vera does seem to take things too personally. For example, the time when Darrell and Pete rushed into Stephen's office and shut the door in her face. I don't honestly believe that it was deliberate on their part. I did talk to her about this. I think she finds it difficult to let some of these perceived slights go and it interferes with her effectiveness with the individuals. The fact that Darrell does not submit receipts timely or at all sometimes is a major issue for Vera but I would hope that with the new policy in place regarding Darrell's receipts there will be a change in his behavior. If not, she has a way to handle the situation. For this policy to work, Vera needs to set firm and clear deadlines for Darrell and then immediately send the missing charges to Ann for reimbursement through payroll as soon as Darrell misses the deadline.

I also talked to Vera about being aware of the tone of her voice. She offended Mike during an X item inventory count when he failed to give her the appropriate inventory listing. As I told Vera, Mike should have given her the appropriate paperwork but when he didn't that did not give her permission to talk down to him. Everyone makes mistakes and they don't do it on purpose. She needs to handle these mistakes without offending others.

At times, Vera can be a talker and for some this is an unwanted distraction. She needs to be more aware of others workload and share only when it is appropriate.

I do believe that Vera felt that she was not always kept in the loop on things and with her ownership of the general ledger and account reconciliations that lack of knowledge prevented her from having answers to questions or variances. She indicated to me, that she was repeatedly told to mind her own business. In a small office, with limited resources, good communication is important and the lack of it can interfere with employee effectiveness.

It is my understanding from Vera, that she was told that she should only look at American Expense once a month. I tend to agree with Vera, that looking at the spend weekly puts her in a better position to record the spend entry faster at the end of the month and gives her the information needed to request missing receipts more timely which will more than likely result in better compliance. It is easier to remember something that happened last week versus several weeks earlier.

I also recommended to Vera that she post the note payments against the long-term portion of the note rather than the short-term portion which would eliminate constantly having to reclass dollars between the two accounts. With this new methodology she would only need to do small reclass journal entries quarterly or even annually.

I would also recommend that some guidelines be set for required receipts. I have learned from my past experience, that setting a threshold below which a receipt is not required helps keep the process moving more efficiently forward. Maybe this is a guideline for Vera to use but something that is not communicated to the American Express users.

If providing Vera with the closing checklist does not change the completeness and timeliness of the financial statements, then I think she may not have the skills needed to handle the job. She is currently behind on balancing accounts. None of the accounts that have not been reconciled carry a large balance but it is always possible that the balance could be the results of two larger entries that partially offset. Vera and I did have a conversation during this last week about prioritizing the reconciliation of the "suspense" type accounts.

Karen Craft

From: Connie Syron
Sent: Friday, August 23, 2019 1:08 PM
To: Ken Livingston; Karen Craft
Subject: Write Ups
Attachments: Vera.docx

Ken and Karen,

Attached are documenting my impressions of Mike, Vera and Sharon. Please let me know if you have any questions.

Thank you,

Connie